Analytics Tableau Style Guide

Purpose

This style guide is meant to help provide a cohesive look and feel for our published Tableau reports in Analytics so our audience will have a consistent user experience. The defined standards will also help improve the report development process for analysts and encourage effective dashboard visualizations. The following are recommendations and can be adjusted depending on the user request and other factors.

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Dashboard Best Practices

Each dashboard should have a **clear purpose or function**. Determine who is the audience, how will they use the dashboard, what information is important to them and what question(s) the dashboard will be answering. Trying to do too much with one dashboard can be confusing to the audience and slow down your workbook performance.

Include **instructions** for any dashboard interactivity to help guide your audience with data navigation and drilldowns.

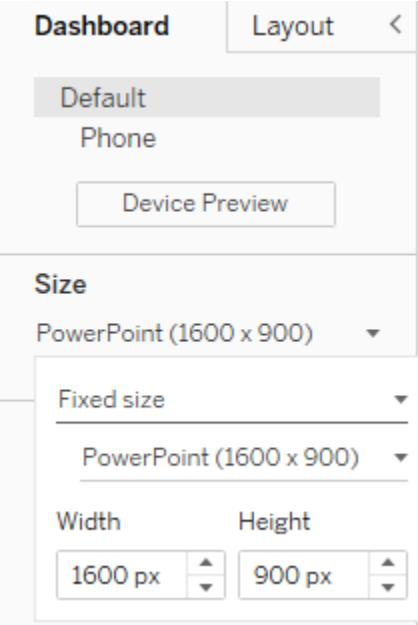
When visualizing data, make sure your views are using **business friendly names** within the title, label and other text. This helps the end user understand the metrics more easily if they are unfamiliar with the source data.

Be mindful about the **number of views or worksheets** in a dashboard. There should be no more than **6 views** in a dashboard. Too many views can lead to workbook inefficiency and audience confusion. Each view should also have a clear purpose.

Similarly, limit the **number of filters** in a dashboard. Excessive filters lead to complex queries in your workbook which can greatly impact workbook performance. Use the Apply button where possible to reduce multiple data refreshes.

Layout

Dashboard **size** should be 1600x900 (PowerPoint size) for minimal scrolling. Try to avoid scrollbars within views. Use **fixed** dashboard size for optimal performance.



The **mandatory elements** of a dashboard are:

- Title
- Logo (amp'd logo for amp'd specific dashboards, Cotality logo for non-amp'd dashboards)
- When the data was last updated
- Dashboard contact
- Data owner (if different from the dashboard contact)

An **optional element** of a dashboard is:

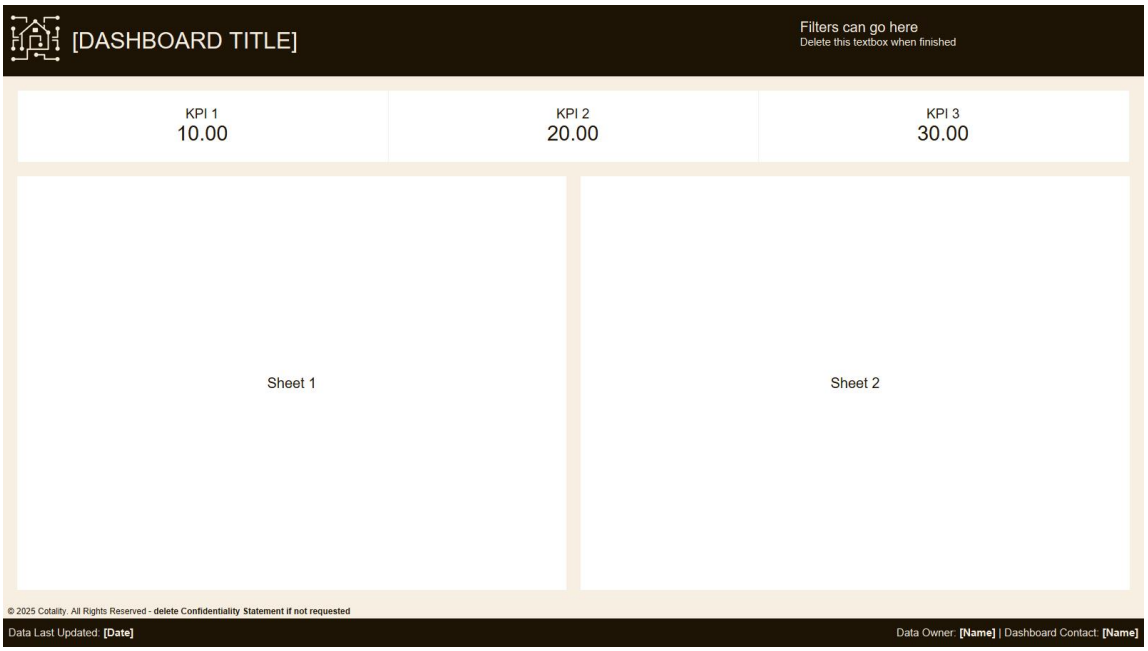
- Confidentiality statement (Only upon stakeholder request or specific use cases. This can be deleted if not applicable)

Dashboard elements can be **tiled or floating**. Use the **tiled option** when possible, as floating elements may not render as expected when published.

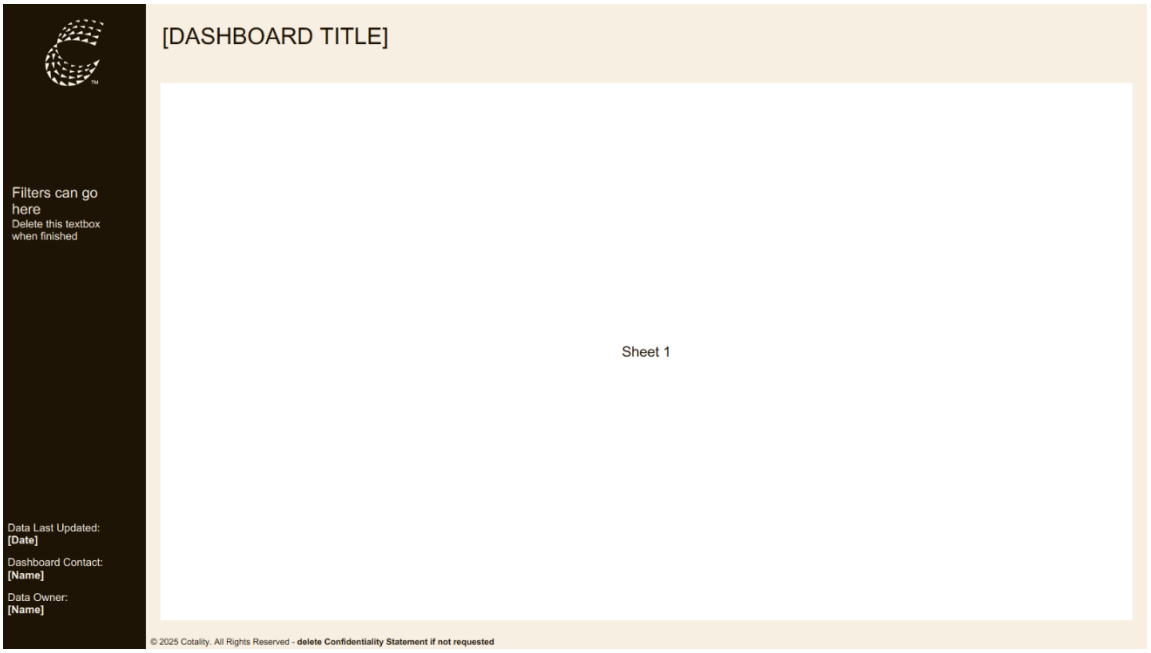
Leverage our **Analytics templates** to save time when developing your dashboard. The templates also provide a consistent look and utilize Cotality's latest branding. There are multiple layout options that can be customized based on your end design.

The header area contains the logo, dashboard title and filters. The footer area contains data source information and contact details. The sidebar contains similar information.

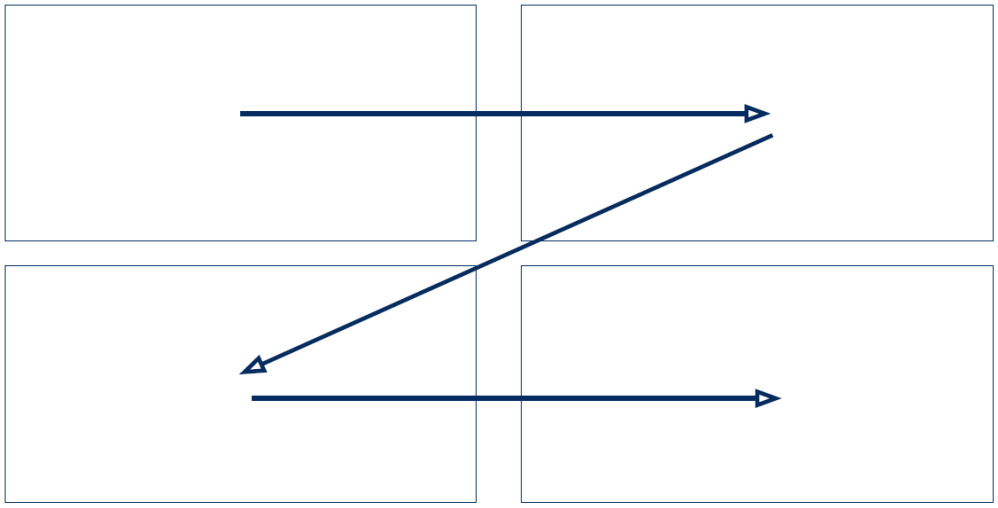
Sample layout with header:



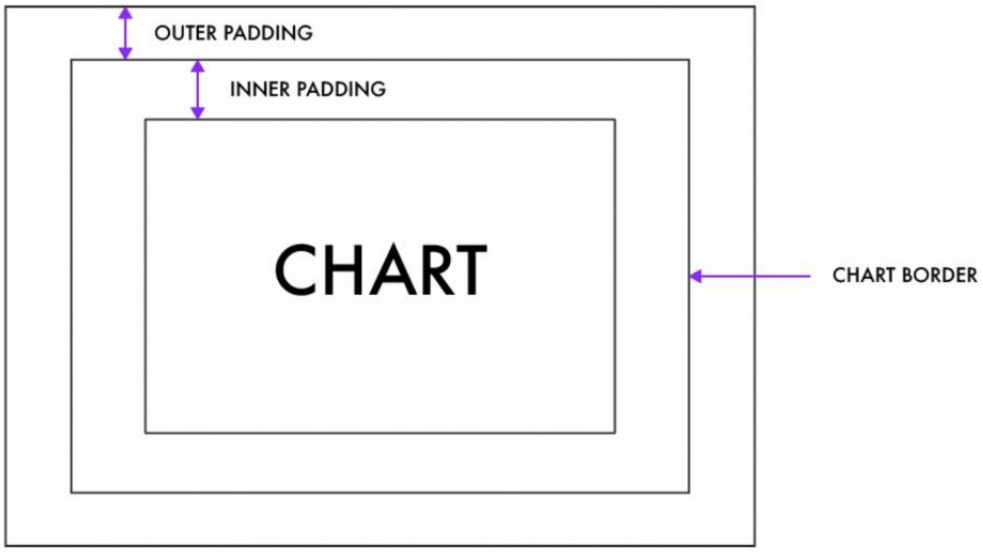
Sample layout with sidebar:



When organizing your information by **importance**, order from top to bottom, left to right. Start with the most important, aggregated metrics at the top like KPIs. Less important and more granular views such as data tables and detailed charts can be placed at the bottom.



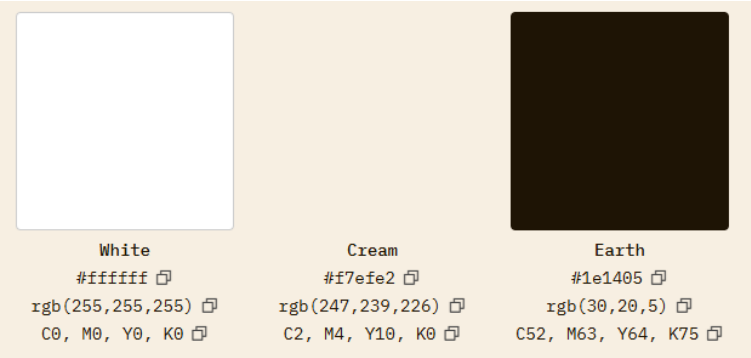
Leverage **whitespace** and **padding** to separate different views. Outer padding adds space outside of the worksheet border while inner padding adds space inside the worksheet border. The Analytics template uses **20px** for outer padding of worksheets (a minimum of 10px is required) and 10-15px for inner padding, which can be adjusted as needed. This is especially impactful if you have more views in your dashboard.



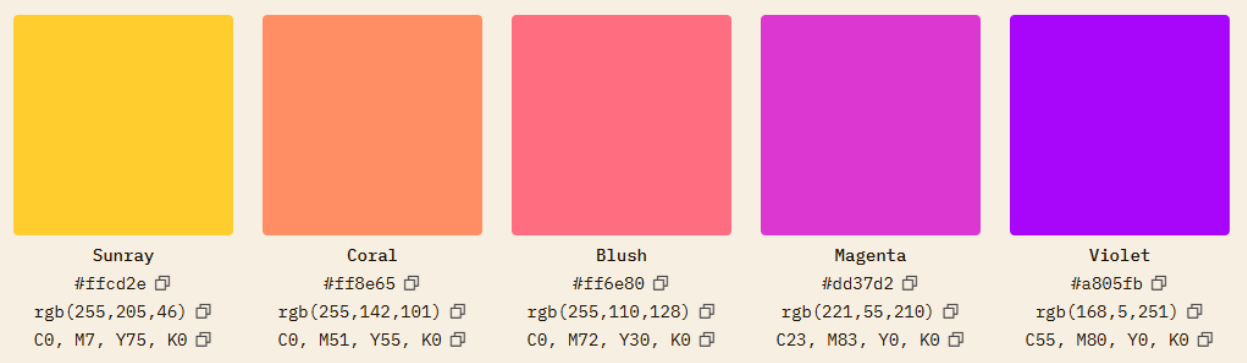
Colors

Currently dashboards must use only colors from Cotality's new branding. This consists of neutrals, a primary palette and extended palette.

Neutrals:



Primary Palette:



To use Cotality's brand colors in your workbook, a custom color palette needs to be created first. Follow these steps to create a custom color palette and easily access brand colors when building your views. The Analytics template instructions will include hex codes of each palette for your convenience.

When building your dashboard, use **1-2 dominant colors** from Cotality's primary palette to highlight important metrics, and neutral shades (grays) for other mark values. The extended palette can be used to supplement your views as needed. Keep colors consistent throughout dashboards in the same workbook. It is helpful to design in grayscale first. Be mindful of **accessibility** for color blindness and **avoid combining** red and green in the same view.

The following color standards, which have been incorporated into the Analytics template, apply to all dashboards:

1) Dashboard header or sidebar color: **Earth**
2) Dashboard background color: **Cream**
3) Chart background color: **White**
4) Overall workbook text color: **Earth**
5) Text color for dashboard elements on an Earth background: **Cream**
6) Metadata text color: **Cream**

For specific use cases, predesigned palettes have been created your convenience and can be found in the template instructions page above. These predesigned palettes have limited color options so please feel free to use a different color from Cotality's palette if your dashboard is using a different dominant color.

1) Cotality Sequential: Use to assign colors to a dimension using variations of a single color, with many dimension members. Current option is Coral.
2) Cotality Diverging: Use to assign colors to a measure that diverges. Current options are Teal and Grey.

Typography

Use **one font** type throughout your dashboard. To ensure the font will display on other users' devices, a web safe font should be used. Use **Arial** for the overall workbook and **Arial Black** for **worksheet titles**. This can be selected when formatting the workbook.

All text that is not set on an Earth background should be **Earth** color.

Limit the number of **font size categories** per workbook. Use the same font size for each category of text. The following recommended font categories and sizes are:

Text	Size
Dashboard Title	24-28
Subtitle/Chart Title	15-16
Chart Header	11-12
Labels/Other Text	10-11

Be thoughtful about using **bolded** text and **all capitals**. These can be used in some areas such as emphasizing main titles and KPIs.

Numbers

Consider **number precision** for readability. Determine how many decimal places is appropriate for the data being displayed. Too many decimal places can clutter your view and make the numbers difficult to read.

Use correct **number formatting** (%, $) and use **number abbreviations** where appropriate (k, M).

When visualizing **KPIs**, use larger font sizes to quickly grab the user's attention and contrast with surrounding text or numbers.

Logo

For amp'd dashboards, use the amp'd logo without text when using the template version that contains the header and footer. Use the amp'd logo with text when using the template version that contains the sidebar.

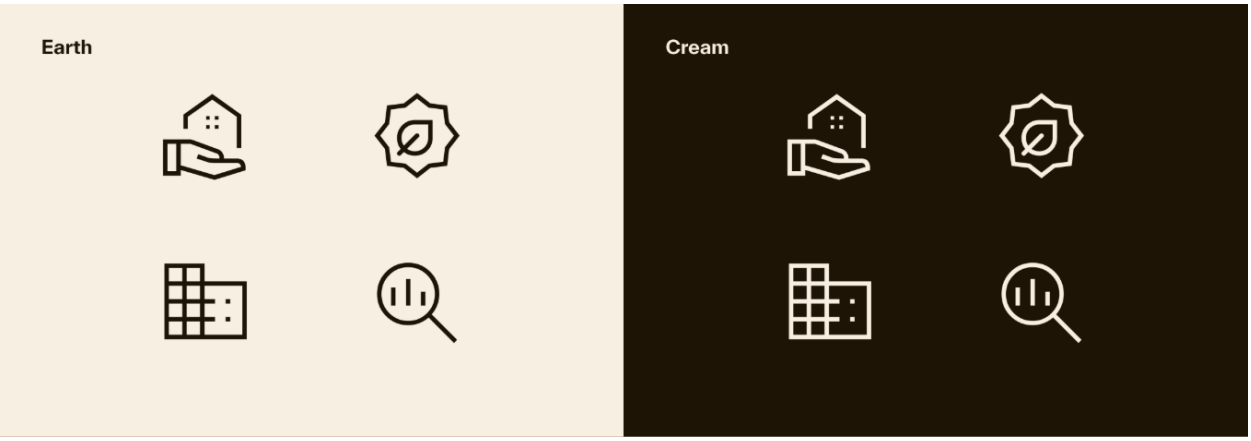
For non-amp'd dashboards, use the Cotality logomark.

Access logo options on SharePoint.

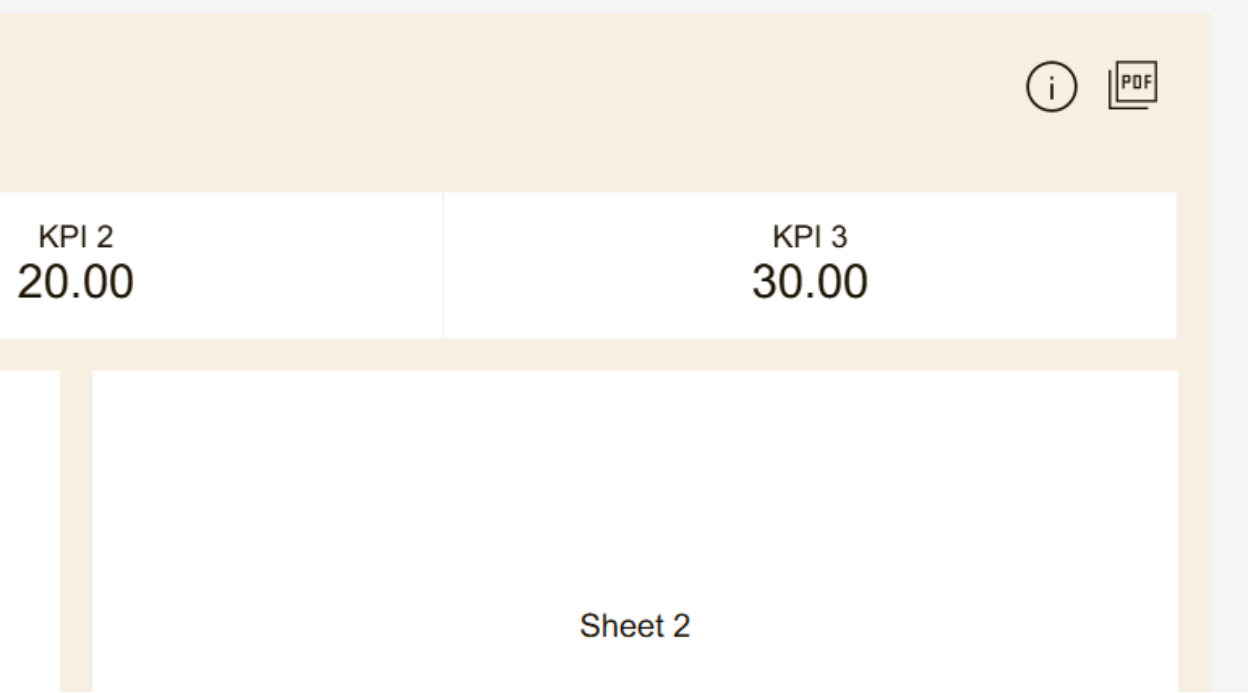
Icons

Use Cotality's new iconography. The instructions and settings for downloading from Google's Material Design are located here. An Optical Size of 48px is recommended for a crisper look.

Earth icons should be used on light backgrounds and Cream icons should be used on dark backgrounds:



If icons such as Information and Export buttons are requested, place them in the upper right corner of the template, with a width of 50px:



Charts

To **reduce clutter**, remove unnecessary chart gridlines and borders.

Also consider how many marks are needed in the view. Too **many marks** may cause information overload and will negatively impact workbook performance.

Label marks or show the axes but not both, for a cleaner visualization.

For **improved readability**, avoid vertically aligned labels and overlapping text where possible.

Utilize **tooltips** to provide helpful information about the data and reduce confusion.

Recommended chart types:

Change over time: Line Chart, Slope Chart, Highlight Table

Correlation: Scatter Plot, Highlight Table

Magnitude: Bar Chart, Bubble Chart, Line Chart

Deviation: Bullet Chart, Bar Chart, Combination Chart

Distribution: Histogram, Population Pyramid, Pareto Chart, Box Plot

Ranking: Bar Chart, Bump Chart

Part-to-Whole: Pie chart, Area Chart, Stacked Bar Chart, Treemap

Spatial: Filled Map, Heat Map, Symbol Map, Hex Map

Flow: Sankey, Waterfall

Common Chart tips:

Line Chart: Having too many lines and colors/categories will cause confusion. It is more effective to highlight one category to easily compare it to the others.

Pie Chart: Use if you have no more than 3-4 categories and the wedge sizes differ significantly.

Bar Chart: Have clearly labeled axes or marks. Do not display too many bars, colors, and subcategories.

Scatter Plot: Clearly label marks and do not have too many marks in a view. Don’t use too many different shapes and colors.

Treemap: Use to visualize a few distinct categories with a distinct hierarchy.

Text Table: Do not use if you are trying to show relationships in your data or there are too many marks and categories.

Highlight Table: Don’t use multiple colors in one table or have similar colors for different measures.